

CURRENT AFFAIRS



USA & PARIS PACT



35th WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 2

ALL EXAMS

28th Aug to 3rd Sept, 2017



United Nations

Framework Convention on
Climate Change



PARIS2015

UN CLIMATE CHANGE CONFERENCE

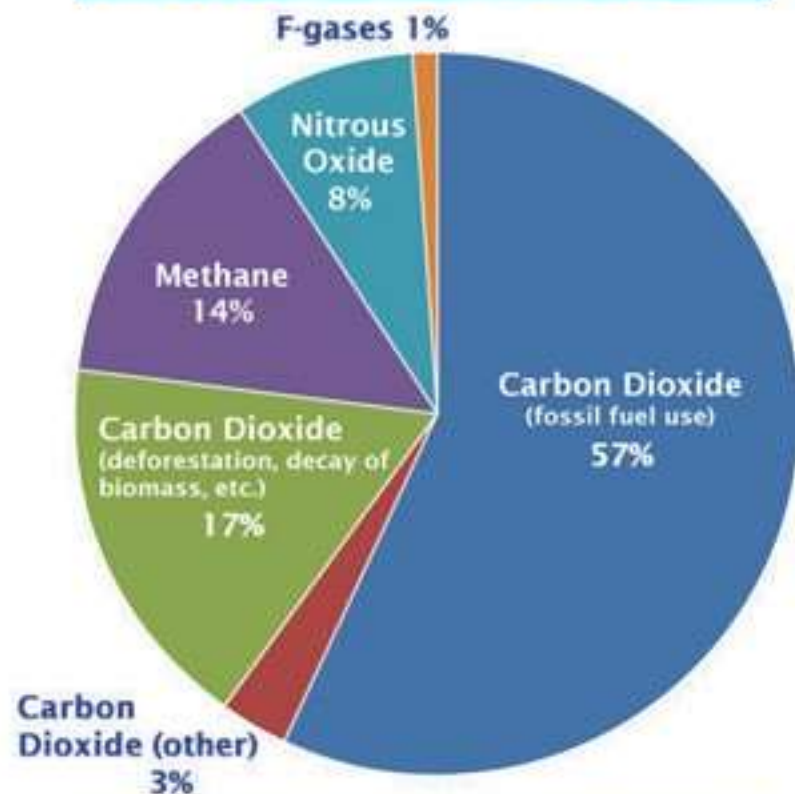
COP21·CMP11

DETAILS

- Paris Climate Treaty is basically reducing Greenhouse Gas emissions.
- This is to limit the temperature raise to 2°C (preferably 1.5°C) by the end of the century, in comparison to pre - industrial levels.
- So as to reduce greenhouse gases, fossil fuels burning should be reduced.
- Each country was asked to submit its own Intended Nationally Determined Contributions (INDCs).



GREEN HOUSE GAS EMISSIONS BY GAS AT GLOBAL LEVEL



(Based on Global Emissions in 2004)
As per IPCC report in 2007

MAIN HUMAN ACTIVITIES

CO ₂	Fossil Fuels & Deforestation
CH ₄ (Methane)	Agricultural activities, waste management & energy use
N ₂ O (Nitrous Oxide)	Agricultural activities such as use of fertilizers
Fluorinated Gases	Industrial processes, refrigeration, etc.



TRUMP ADMINISTRATION ... FIRST WRITTEN NOTIFICATION



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- USA has given written notification for withdrawal from Paris Pact.
- However, the US also stated that Washington would remain in the talks process.
- The US President felt that it punished the US and would cost millions of American jobs.
- It is largely seen as symbolic.
- No Nation seeking to leave the pact can officially announce an intention to withdraw until 4 November, 2019 because three years is the minimum time.
- The process of leaving subsequently takes another year, meaning it would not be complete until weeks after the US Presidential Election in 2020.
- The final decision rests with the new US President.



IN THE MINDS OF OBAMA & XI JINPING



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- 1 The key relationship that brokered the Paris agreement was between the USA and China.
- 2 Both Obama and Xi Jinping found the common ground to build coalition of high ambition with small island states and the EU
- 3 Obama felt that because of fracking revolution and production of natural gas, costs plummeted and carbon emissions will certainly fall. In fact, US energy production is now powered more by gas than coal.



GLOBAL WARMING ... REAL/HOAX? ... SEE THE PARADOX!



A report compiled by US Government confirmed that, 2016 was the warmest year on record and third year in a row of record global warmth.



It is based on contributions from nearly 500 scientists from more than 60 countries.

- The heat was the result of long term global warming and a strong El Nino weather phenomenon.
- Global surface temperatures and sea levels and green house gases were all at record highs.
- Carbon dioxide, methane and Nitrous oxide are the major green house gases and have risen to new heights.
- Global annual average atmospheric CO₂ concentration was 402.9 Parts Per Million (PPM) and this surpassed 400 PPM for the first time.
- The report said that, climate change is one of the most pressing issues facing humanity and life on Earth.



GLOBALLY, WHAT IS HAPPENING?



- 1 UK is going to phase out the coal for the generation of electricity by 2025.
- 2 Now, coal is unlikely to become a major player in developed countries, but in developing countries, it may continue to be a source of energy for some more time.
- 3 The number of jobs in US coal industry is just half of the number employed in solar.
- 4 In recent auctions in India, the solar price is 18% lower than the average price of electricity generated by coal fired plants.



WHAT DO YOU KNOW BY TRUMP FOREST?

TRUMP FOREST

This is the campaign to plant trees to compensate for the impact of President Trump's climate policies.



- 1 Trump Forest allows people either to plant locally or pay for trees in a number of poorer countries.
- 2 The project was started by the campaigners upset at what they call President's ignorance on climate science.

Donald Trump, while coming out of the Paris Pact stated that, the climate pact will damage the US economy and it will cost the jobs and give a competitive advantage to the countries such as India and China.



WHAT DO YOU KNOW BY TRUMP FOREST?



The decision of Trump also led to the disappointment of global business leaders, which include leaders of Google, Apple and hundreds of other major corporates, including major fossil fuel producers like Exxon Mobil.

- 3** Based in New Zealand, the project began in March this year and so far has gained pledges from around 450 people based all around the world.
- 4** The organisers estimate that, they will need to offset 650 mega tonnes of CO₂ equivalent by 2025 to compensate the President's policies.
- 5** This translates into more than 100 billion new trees, that means, it requires massive scale of plantation.



WHAT ARE ITS REPERCUSSIONS OF USA COMING OUT OF PARIS PACT?



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- 1 The US contributes about 15% of global emissions of carbon and it may have its effect in keeping the global temperature rise well below the level of 2°C.
- 2 US is also a significant source of finance and technology for developing countries in their efforts to fight rising temperatures.
- 3 This will strengthen China as a global leader in climate efforts.



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4

Canada and Mexico could emerge as significant players from the Americas in global efforts to stem rising temperatures.

5

The shift in the US away from coal resulted in several decisions in other developed countries. Now, we have to see the effect of USA on other developed countries.

Under these circumstances, US pulling out of climate deal may not make much difference to the carbon emissions.

Overall, the carbon emissions will continue to fall because of alternate sources of energy.

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